

ASC Accreditation Roadmap

12-Month Compliance Calendar & Deliverable Tracker

Product: Ambulatory Surgery Center Compliance Manual — Tier 1
Version: 1.0
Applicable Standards: CMS Conditions for Coverage (42 CFR Part 416), AAAHC Standards, State Licensure Requirements

How to Use This Roadmap

This document provides a month-by-month action plan for achieving and maintaining ASC accreditation. Each month contains:

- **Compliance milestones** tied to CMS and AAAHC requirements
- **Required documentation** you must prepare or update
- **Submission deadlines** and internal due dates
- **Responsible party** assignments for small teams (1–2 compliance staff)

Tip for Small Teams: Block 4–6 hours per week exclusively for compliance work. Treat it like a clinical shift — non-negotiable.

Annual Compliance Overview

Quarter	Focus Area	CMS Reference	AAAHC Chapter
Q1 (Months 1–3)	Foundation & Gap Analysis	42 CFR §416.41–416.52	Chapters 1–5
Q2 (Months 4–6)	Policy Development & Staff Training	42 CFR §416.50–416.54	Chapters 6–10
Q3 (Months 7–9)	Implementation & Mock Surveys	42 CFR §416.44–416.48	Chapters 11–15
Q4 (Months 10–12)	Final Prep, Submission & Continuous QI	42 CFR §416.43	All Chapters

Month 1: Baseline Assessment & Gap Analysis

Compliance Milestones

- [] Complete facility-wide gap analysis against current CMS Conditions for Coverage
- [] Identify all areas of non-compliance or partial compliance
- [] Establish compliance committee (even if 2 people — formalize it with meeting minutes)
- [] Verify current state licensure status and renewal dates

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Gap Analysis Report	§416.41 (Governing Body)	☐ Not Started	Month 1, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Compliance Committee Charter	§416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 1, Week 3	Administrator
Current License Inventory	State Requirements	☐ Not Started	Month 1, Week 1	Compliance Lead
Organizational Chart	§416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 1, Week 2	Administrator
Governing Body Bylaws Review	§416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 1, Week 4	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** Gap analysis complete by end of Week 2
- **External:** None this month (planning phase)
- **State:** Verify licensure renewal date; if within 6 months, begin renewal paperwork immediately

Action Items for Small Teams

1. Download the latest CMS State Operations Manual, Appendix L (ASC interpretive guidelines)
2. Print AAAHC standards handbook — tab each chapter for quick reference
3. Create a shared digital folder structure mirroring accreditation chapters
4. Schedule recurring weekly 1-hour compliance huddle

Month 2: Governing Body & Administrative Framework

Compliance Milestones

- [] Establish or update Governing Body structure and meeting schedule
- [] Document transfer agreement(s) with local hospital(s) — or physician admission privileges
- [] Review and update facility bylaws
- [] Verify medical director qualifications and appointment documentation

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Governing Body Meeting Minutes (template)	\$416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 2, Week 1	Administrator
Transfer Agreement (current, signed)	\$416.41(b)	☐ Not Started	Month 2, Week 3	Administrator
Medical Director Credentials File	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 2, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Bylaws (updated, board-approved)	\$416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 2, Week 4	Administrator
Disclosure of Ownership (CMS-855B)	\$416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 2, Week 2	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All governing body documents finalized by Week 4
- **External:** Transfer agreement must be executed (signed by both parties) — no CMS deadline but required at survey
- **State:** Check if state requires separate transfer agreement filing

Critical Notes

CMS Hot Button: Transfer agreements are one of the top 5 deficiency areas. Ensure the agreement is current (not expired), signed by authorized representatives at both the ASC and hospital, and specifies the hospital will accept transfers. If using physician admission privileges instead, maintain current privilege verification letters for every physician on your roster.

Month 3: Patient Rights & Quality Assessment

Compliance Milestones

- [] Develop or update Patient Rights policy and notice
- [] Establish Quality Assessment and Performance Improvement (QAPI) program
- [] Create grievance/complaint resolution procedure
- [] Develop informed consent process and templates
- [] Establish advance directive policy

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Patient Rights Policy & Notice	\$416.50	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 2	Compliance Lead
QAPI Program Description	\$416.43	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 3	Quality Lead
Grievance Policy & Log Template	\$416.50(a)	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Informed Consent Templates (by procedure)	\$416.50(a)	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 4	Clinical Lead
Advance Directive Policy	\$416.50(a)(2)	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 3	Compliance Lead
QAPI Meeting Minutes Template	\$416.43	☐ Not Started	Month 3, Week 3	Quality Lead

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** QAPI program description approved by Governing Body by Week 4
- **External:** None — but QAPI must be active and demonstrable at survey
- **State:** Some states require patient rights posted in specific languages — verify local requirements

Month 4: Infection Control Program

Compliance Milestones

- [] Appoint Infection Control Officer (can be dual-role for small ASCs)
- [] Develop comprehensive Infection Control Program
- [] Establish surveillance, tracking, and reporting protocols
- [] Verify sterile processing procedures and documentation
- [] Conduct baseline infection control risk assessment

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Infection Control Program Manual	\$416.51	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 3	IC Officer
IC Officer Appointment Letter & Qualifications	\$416.51(a)	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 1	Administrator
Infection Surveillance Log Template	\$416.51(a)	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 2	IC Officer
Sterilization Logs & Biological Indicator Records	\$416.51(b)	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 2	IC Officer
IC Risk Assessment (annual)	\$416.51 / AAAHC Ch. 9	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 4	IC Officer
Hand Hygiene Policy	\$416.51	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 1	IC Officer
Antibiotic Stewardship Policy	\$416.51	☐ Not Started	Month 4, Week 3	IC Officer

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** IC program manual approved by Governing Body by end of Month 4
- **External:** Report any reportable infections to state health department per state timelines
- **CMS:** Infection control is surveyed under \$416.51 — one of the highest-cited deficiency areas

Critical Notes

Surveyor Focus Area: Surveyors WILL observe hand hygiene, PPE use, instrument processing, and environmental cleaning during the on-site visit. They will also request 12 months of surveillance data. Start tracking NOW — even if you have zero infections, document that you have zero infections each month.

Month 5: Pharmaceutical & Medication Management

Compliance Milestones

- [] Develop medication management policies (ordering, storage, dispensing, administration)
- [] Verify controlled substance protocols and DEA compliance
- [] Establish adverse drug event reporting process

- [] Audit medication storage areas (temperature logs, expiration checks, security)
- [] Develop medication reconciliation process

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Medication Management Policy	\$416.48	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 2	Clinical Lead
Controlled Substance Log Template	\$416.48 / DEA	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 1	Clinical Lead
Medication Storage Temperature Log	\$416.48	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 1	Clinical Lead
Adverse Drug Event Reporting Policy	\$416.48	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 3	Clinical Lead
Medication Reconciliation Form	\$416.48	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 3	Clinical Lead
Pharmacy Consultant Agreement (if applicable)	\$416.48	☐ Not Started	Month 5, Week 4	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All medication policies approved by Month 5, Week 4
- **External:** DEA registration must be current and posted
- **State:** Verify state pharmacy board requirements for ASC medication management

Month 6: Environment of Care & Safety

Compliance Milestones

- [] Complete Life Safety Code assessment (NFPA 101)
- [] Verify fire alarm and suppression system compliance
- [] Conduct fire drill (document it — this is required quarterly)
- [] Review and update Emergency Preparedness Plan
- [] Verify medical gas system compliance and documentation
- [] Complete equipment maintenance inventory

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Life Safety Code Compliance Report	\$416.44 / NFPA 101	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 3	Facilities
Fire Drill Documentation (quarterly)	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 2	Safety Officer
Emergency Preparedness Plan	\$416.54	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 4	Administrator
Equipment Maintenance Log (all devices)	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 2	Facilities
Medical Gas Inspection Records	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 1	Facilities
HVAC Maintenance & Air Exchange Records	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 2	Facilities
Hazardous Materials Inventory	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 6, Week 3	Safety Officer

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** Emergency preparedness plan approved by Governing Body by Week 4
- **External:** Fire marshal inspection must be current (annually in most states)
- **State:** Verify state-specific life safety requirements — some exceed federal standards

Critical Notes

Survey Day Reality: Surveyors will physically walk the facility. They check exit signage, fire extinguisher inspection tags, electrical panel clearance (36 inches), crash cart seal integrity, and medication refrigerator temperatures. A single expired fire extinguisher tag can trigger a deficiency. Walk your facility monthly with fresh eyes.

Month 7: Surgical & Anesthesia Services

Compliance Milestones

- [] Review and update surgical services policies
- [] Verify anesthesia services compliance (CRNAs, anesthesiologists, supervision requirements)
- [] Audit operative and anesthesia records for completeness

- [] Verify post-anesthesia care protocols
- [] Confirm discharge criteria documentation

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Surgical Services Policy Manual	\$416.42	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 3	Clinical Director
Anesthesia Services Policy	\$416.42(b)	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 2	Anesthesia Lead
Operative Record Template Audit	\$416.47	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 2	Clinical Lead
Post-Anesthesia Discharge Criteria	\$416.42(b)(3)	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 3	Anesthesia Lead
Pre-Operative Assessment Template	\$416.42	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 1	Clinical Lead
Anesthesia Equipment Check Log	\$416.42(b)	☐ Not Started	Month 7, Week 1	Anesthesia Lead

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All surgical and anesthesia policies approved by Month 7, Week 4
- **External:** Anesthesia provider credentialing must be current
- **State:** Verify state scope-of-practice requirements for CRNAs

Month 8: Medical Records & Health Information

Compliance Milestones

- [] Audit medical record completeness (minimum 10 charts)
- [] Verify HIPAA compliance documentation
- [] Establish record retention policy
- [] Verify authentication requirements for all entries
- [] Confirm medical records are available and organized

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Medical Record Audit Results (10+ charts)	§416.47	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 3	Compliance Lead
Medical Record Policy	§416.47	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 2	Compliance Lead
HIPAA Privacy & Security Policies	§416.47 / HIPAA	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 3	Privacy Officer
Record Retention Schedule	§416.47	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Chart Completion Checklist	§416.47	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 1	Clinical Lead
Business Associate Agreements (current)	HIPAA	☐ Not Started	Month 8, Week 4	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** Chart audit complete by Week 3 with corrective actions identified
- **External:** HIPAA breach reporting (if applicable) per HHS timelines
- **State:** Verify state medical record retention requirements (may exceed federal)

Month 9: Credentialing & Privileging

Compliance Milestones

- [] Audit all physician and provider credential files
- [] Verify current privileging for all providers performing procedures
- [] Confirm NPDB query completion (within 2 years)
- [] Verify licensure, DEA, malpractice insurance for all providers
- [] Update credentialing policies and peer review process

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Credentialing Policy	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 2	Administrator
Provider Credential Files (each provider)	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 3	Compliance Lead
Privilege Delineation Forms (by specialty)	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 2	Medical Director
NPDB Query Verification	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 1	Compliance Lead
Peer Review Policy & Minutes	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 3	Medical Director
Malpractice Insurance Verification	\$416.45	☐ Not Started	Month 9, Week 1	Compliance Lead

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All credentialing files 100% complete by Month 9, Week 4
- **External:** NPDB queries must be current (within 2 years per AAAHC; CMS expects at initial privileging and reappointment)
- **State:** Verify state credentialing timeline requirements

Critical Notes

#1 Deficiency Nationally: Credentialing and privileging deficiencies are the most frequently cited issue in ASC surveys. Every single provider file MUST contain: current license, DEA (if applicable), board certification verification, malpractice insurance, NPDB query, privilege delineation, and peer references. Missing ONE document in ONE file = deficiency.

Month 10: Mock Survey & Remediation

Compliance Milestones

- [] Conduct comprehensive mock survey (use Survey Readiness Checklist)
- [] Document all findings with severity rating
- [] Develop Plans of Correction for each finding
- [] Begin remediation of all identified deficiencies
- [] Conduct staff interviews using surveyor-style questions

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Mock Survey Report	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 10, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Plan of Correction (for each finding)	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 10, Week 3	All Owners
Staff Interview Q&A Results	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 10, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Remediation Tracking Log	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 10, Week 4	Compliance Lead
Updated Policies (corrected items)	Varies	☐ Not Started	Month 10, Week 4	All Owners

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** Mock survey completed by Week 2; all POCs drafted by Week 3; remediation underway by Week 4
- **External:** None
- **Note:** If accreditation survey is scheduled, verify exact date and count backward

Month 11: Final Preparation & Staff Readiness

Compliance Milestones

- [] Complete all remediation from mock survey findings
- [] Conduct second mini-mock focusing on top deficiency areas
- [] Ensure all staff can articulate their roles in key policies
- [] Verify all physical environment items (signage, fire equipment, emergency supplies)
- [] Confirm all documentation binders/systems are organized and accessible
- [] Prepare surveyor welcome packet

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Remediation Completion Verification	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 2	Compliance Lead
Staff Competency Attestations	\$416.46	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 2	Clinical Lead
Surveyor Welcome Packet	N/A	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 3	Administrator
Document Index (master list of all policies)	N/A	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 1	Compliance Lead
Final Environment Walk-through Report	\$416.44	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 3	Facilities
Emergency Contact List (updated)	\$416.54	☐ Not Started	Month 11, Week 1	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All remediation 100% complete by Week 2; facility tour-ready by Week 3
- **External:** Submit accreditation application (if initial survey) per accrediting body timeline
- **AAAH:** Application typically required 90–120 days before desired survey date

Month 12: Survey Readiness & Continuous Compliance

Compliance Milestones

- [] Conduct final walkthrough — facility must be “survey-ready” every single day
- [] Verify all logs are current (temperature, sterilization, fire drills, equipment)
- [] Confirm QAPI data is current with at least 2 completed improvement projects
- [] Review all meeting minutes (Governing Body, QAPI, IC, Peer Review)
- [] Establish ongoing compliance calendar for next 12 months

Required Documentation

Document	CMS Reference	Status	Due Date	Owner
Final Compliance Status Report	All sections	☐ Not Started	Month 12, Week 1	Compliance Lead
QAPI Annual Report	§416.43	☐ Not Started	Month 12, Week 2	Quality Lead
Annual IC Risk Assessment (completed)	§416.51	☐ Not Started	Month 12, Week 1	IC Officer
Governing Body Annual Review Minutes	§416.41	☐ Not Started	Month 12, Week 2	Administrator
Year 2 Compliance Calendar (draft)	N/A	☐ Not Started	Month 12, Week 4	Compliance Lead
Accreditation Application (if applicable)	Per accreditor	☐ Not Started	Per accreditor deadline	Administrator

Submission Deadlines

- **Internal:** All documentation finalized and indexed
- **External:** Accreditation survey may occur during this month or Month 1 of next cycle
- **CMS:** Medicare enrollment revalidation — verify revalidation due date on PECOS

Recurring Monthly Requirements

The following items must be completed **every month** regardless of where you are in the 12-month cycle:

Task	Frequency	CMS Reference	Owner
Governing Body meeting (or documented communication)	Monthly or per bylaws	§416.41	Administrator
QAPI data collection and review	Monthly	§416.43	Quality Lead
Infection surveillance tracking	Monthly	§416.51	IC Officer
Medication storage temperature logs	Daily (reviewed monthly)	§416.48	Clinical Lead
Equipment maintenance checks	Per manufacturer schedule	§416.44	Facilities
Sterilization biological indicator testing	Per policy (weekly minimum)	§416.51	IC Officer
Fire/safety rounds	Monthly	§416.44	Safety Officer
Crash cart checks	Per policy (daily when OR active)	§416.44	Clinical Lead
Controlled substance counts	Per policy (each shift minimum)	§416.48	Clinical Lead
Staff competency observations	Ongoing	§416.46	Clinical Director

Recurring Quarterly Requirements

Task	Quarter	CMS Reference	Owner
Fire drill (documented)	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.44	Safety Officer
QAPI committee meeting with minutes	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.43	Quality Lead
Infection control committee review	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.51	IC Officer
Policy review (rotating section each quarter)	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	All	Compliance Lead
Emergency preparedness drill	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.54	Administrator
Credentialing file spot-check (3 files minimum)	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.45	Compliance Lead
Environment of care rounds	Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4	§416.44	Facilities

Recurring Annual Requirements

Task	Deadline	CMS Reference	Owner
Infection Control Risk Assessment	Anniversary of last assessment	§416.51	IC Officer
Emergency Preparedness Plan review and update	Annually	§416.54	Administrator
QAPI Annual Effectiveness Review	End of compliance year	§416.43	Quality Lead
Credentialing/re-privileging cycle	Per policy (typically every 2 years)	§416.45	Medical Director
HIPAA risk assessment	Annually	HIPAA Security Rule	Privacy Officer
Policy manual comprehensive review	Annually	All	Compliance Lead
Life Safety Code inspection	Annually (or per AHJ)	§416.44	Facilities
Fire alarm and suppression system inspection	Annually	NFPA	Facilities
Medical gas system certification	Annually	NFPA 99	Facilities
Staff TB screening / health requirements	Annually (or per policy)	§416.51 / OSHA	IC Officer
Governing Body annual organizational review	Annually	§416.41	Administrator

Key Contacts & Resources

Resource	URL / Contact	Purpose
CMS State Operations Manual, Appendix L	cms.gov — Search “Appendix L”	Official ASC survey guidance
AAHC Standards	aaahc.org	Accreditation standards handbook
State Health Department	Varies by state	Licensure, reportable events
NPDB	npdb.hrsa.gov	Provider background checks
PECOS	pecos.cms.hhs.gov	Medicare enrollment management
OSHA	osha.gov	Workplace safety requirements
Fire Marshal (local)	Varies	Life Safety Code inspections

Document Version Control

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	Initial Release	ASC Compliance Team	Original 12-month roadmap

This document is part of the ASC Compliance Manual — Tier 1: Essential Compliance Package (\$97). For the complete system including staff training matrices, policy templates, and quarterly update frameworks, upgrade to Tier 2: Complete Certification System (\$197).